

DOWNLOADABLE GUIDE



PALMISTRY GUIDE

by

Tara

*Learn to read hands from scratch,
step by step and at your own pace*

SHAPES · MOUNTS · LINES · SIGNS · EXERCISES

taraoraculo.com

TARA'S PALMISTRY GUIDE

A guide to learning to read hands from scratch, step by step and at your own pace.



© 2026 Cristina Ruza Vázquez · Tara
taraoraculo.com

All rights reserved. This guide is for your personal use only. It may not be reproduced, distributed or sold, in whole or in part, without the author's written permission.

The texts, design and diagrams of this guide are original.

Palmistry is a tool for personal reflection and entertainment. Its content does not constitute medical, psychological, legal or financial advice and does not replace professional care. No line on the hand predicts lifespan or health.



Contents

Welcome	3
1. What palmistry is	5
2. The shape of the hand	9
3. The fingers and the thumb	15
4. The mounts of the hand	20
5. The three main lines	26
6. The minor lines	34
7. Special signs and marks	41
8. Time in the hand	44
9. How to give a reading	46
10. Your first month reading hands	51
Quick reference	55
Farewell	57



Welcome

A letter from Tara to you

Welcome. If you're holding this guide in your hands, chances are you've sometimes found yourself staring at your palms in silence, wondering what those lines are telling you that nobody ever taught you to read. I did the same many years ago, sitting by a window with a cup of tea going cold beside me. That small curiosity grew into a path that still surprises me today.

I want to begin by telling you something important: your hands are not a sentence. They don't hold a destiny carved in stone or a script you have to obey. They are, rather, a living mirror. They reflect your temperament, the way you think and feel, your tendencies and also your possibilities. The palmistry you're about to learn here is a tool for self-discovery and enjoyment, a way of looking at yourself with more calm and more tenderness. Nothing more, and nothing less.

I've written this guide with you in mind, starting from zero. You don't need any previous experience or special gifts; just attention, patience and a desire to observe. We'll go step by step, from the general to the specific, like learning to recognise the trees in a forest before you look at each leaf.

Here is what you'll find in the coming pages:

- ✦ **The foundations:** what palmistry is, where it comes from and the spirit in which it's best practised.
- ✦ **The shape of the hand:** the four elemental types, Earth, Air, Fire and Water, and what they say about your character.
- ✦ **The fingers and the thumb:** how their length, shape and flexibility reveal the way you act.
- ✦ **The mounts:** the little hills of the palm and the energies they represent.
- ✦ **The major and minor lines:** Life, Head and Heart, and then Fate, Sun, Mercury and many more.
- ✦ **The special signs:** stars, crosses, islands and other markings that add nuance to a reading.
- ✦ **Time in the hand:** how events are placed approximately, and why it should be done with caution.
- ✦ **Practice:** a step-by-step reading method with a complete example, a plan for your first month and quick-reference tables.

A piece of advice before you start: read with your own hands in front of you. Open them under good light, compare them, touch them. Palmistry is learned with the eyes and with the fingers, not just with the head. And when a section proves tricky, don't get discouraged; come back to it another day. Hands are patient, and so can you be.

I'd also ask one thing of you: use what you learn with respect. When you read someone else's hands, remember that they are trusting you with something intimate. Speak with care, listen more than you interpret and always leave the last word to the person in front of you. Nobody knows a life better than the one living it.

I'm so happy to be walking with you on this journey. I hope that by the end of the guide you'll look at your palms differently: with curiosity, with affection and with the certainty that you are still the one drawing your path.

With love,

Tara



What palmistry is

History, ethics and how to prepare to read

Your hands take part in almost everything you do, and yet you rarely stop to look at them properly. Those crisscrossing lines, those little rises and hollows, the way your fingers fall open when you let out a sigh... All of it has been with you since the day you were born. In this first chapter we set off on the journey together: I'll walk with you step by step so you can learn to see a hand with new eyes.

Before we begin, I want to make one thing clear, because everything else rests on it: palmistry is not a verdict, and it isn't a fixed map of your future. It's a tool for self-discovery, a symbolic mirror and, yes, a lovely form of entertainment and conversation. Your hand doesn't decide for you. You decide. At most, your hand suggests some interesting questions that are worth asking yourself.

♦ A SHORT TRIP THROUGH HISTORY

The habit of studying hands to understand character is so old that it's hard to give it a birthday. Many scholars trace its roots to India, where it formed part of *Samudrika Shastra*, a body of traditional knowledge that read the features of the body as a reflection of a person's nature. From there, so the story goes, these ideas travelled with merchants, pilgrims and wanderers to other lands.

China also developed its own tradition of reading faces and hands, closely tied to its vision of balance between complementary forces and to the careful observation of nature. Rather than fortune-telling, it set out to understand someone's temperament and the way they relate to the world.

In ancient Greece, interest in the hand was woven into the philosophy of the time. Aristotle mentioned the lines of the hand in his observations on living things, and later tradition credited him with an important role in spreading the art, although many of those claims belong more to legend than to proven history. What did reach us from the Greco-Roman world is a custom we still use today: linking each area of the hand to a god or a planet. That's where names like Jupiter, Saturn, Apollo, Mercury, Venus and Mars come from, and you'll get to know them all in the chapters ahead.

In medieval and Renaissance Europe, palmistry went through times of splendour and suspicion in equal measure. Treatises were written, hands covered in symbols were drawn and, at the same

time, there were periods when it was viewed with distrust. Even so, it never disappeared: it passed from hand to hand, quite literally, through fairs, salons and libraries.

The great modern leap came in the nineteenth century. In France, writers such as Casimir d'Arpentigny turned their attention to the shape of the hand and fingers and proposed classifications that still inspire those of us who read palms today. And between the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries came the most famous figure of all: Cheiro, the stage name of the Irishman William John Warner. Cheiro read the hands of celebrities of his day, published hugely popular books and turned palmistry into a social phenomenon on both sides of the Atlantic. His pseudonym comes from *cheir*, the Greek word for "hand".

During the twentieth century, palmistry drew closer to the language of psychology and character, and systems such as the four elements, which you'll meet in the next chapter, became popular. That's the tradition you and I are part of: ancient, alive and always evolving.

✦ WHAT A HAND CAN AND CAN'T TELL YOU

I like to be honest with you from the very start. A hand speaks of tendencies, talents, ways of reacting, how you manage your energy and the themes that keep coming back in your life. It's a symbolic language and, like every symbolic language, it's read with nuance.

This is what you can explore through palmistry:

- ✦ Your temperament and your natural way of facing things.
- ✦ Your talents, leanings and inner resources.
- ✦ Your style in relationships, in love and in communication.
- ✦ The way you work, make decisions and manage your energy.
- ✦ The personal challenges that invite you to grow.

And this is what a hand **cannot** tell you, and what you will never find in this guide:

- ✦ How long you'll live, or when your life, or anyone else's, will end.
- ✦ Whether you'll fall ill, or any kind of diagnosis.
- ✦ Pregnancies, how many children you'll have, divorces or accidents.
- ✦ Medical, legal or financial decisions: that's what professionals are for.

An important reminder.

If you ever read in a book, or hear in a reading, that a line "foretells" some misfortune, take a deep breath: it doesn't. Lines change over the years, and your life depends on your choices, not on a crease in your skin. For anything to do with your health, always see a healthcare professional.

✦ DOMINANT AND NON-DOMINANT HAND

One of the first questions people ask is: which hand do I read? The short answer is both. The long answer is a lot more beautiful.

The **non-dominant hand** (your left if you write with your right, and the other way round if you're left-handed) is usually read as the realm of potential: what you came in with, your basic leanings, your inner world and the seeds you carry inside.

The **dominant hand**, the one you write with and use for almost everything, reflects what you've developed: how you've tended those seeds, what you've done with your talents, the habits you've built and the way you show yourself to the world today.

Compare the two and some fascinating stories appear. If they look very alike, you're probably living in harmony with your nature. If they're very different, perhaps you've changed a great deal along the way, or maybe there's a talent waiting for you to give it some attention. If you use both hands equally, notice which one you choose for the most delicate tasks and treat that one as dominant.

✦ HOW TO PREPARE FOR A READING

Reading a hand is a small ritual. You don't need candles or incense (although if you enjoy them, go ahead), but you do need a few basic conditions so you can see clearly and the other person feels at ease.

- 1 **Find good light.** Natural light near a window is your best friend. At night, use a white lamp you can move around to create a little side shadow: that way the raised areas and the fine lines show up far better.
- 2 **Ask permission.** Before you touch someone's hand, ask. It sounds obvious, but it's the gesture that makes the difference between reading with respect and simply being nosy.
- 3 **Invite them to relax their hand.** Ask the person to rest it gently on yours or on a table, fingers loose. A tense hand hides information and changes its natural shape.
- 4 **Look before you interpret.** Spend at least a minute looking in silence. Notice the shape, the colour, how the fingers open and which areas stand out. Quick conclusions are usually the least accurate.
- 5 **Touch with respect.** You can press the palm gently to feel its consistency, or carefully bend a finger to see how flexible it is. Always do it without forcing anything, and explain what you're doing.
- 6 **Look at both hands.** Start with the dominant hand if you want to talk about the present, then compare it with the other one.

✦ THE THREE LAYERS OF A READING

So you don't get lost among so many details, I suggest you always read in layers, from the general to the specific. It's like approaching a landscape: first you see the mountains, then the trees and, finally, the leaves.

LAYER	WHAT YOU LOOK AT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
-------	------------------	-------------------

1. Shape	Proportion of palm and fingers, texture, consistency, flexibility and colour	The underlying temperament and the dominant element
2. Mounts and fingers	The raised areas of the palm, the length and shape of each finger, the thumb	Where energy gathers, talents and areas of interest
3. Lines and signs	Major lines, minor lines and small markings	Nuances, life stages and personal themes that shift over time

Lots of people want to jump straight to the lines, and I understand why: they're the most eye-catching part. But the same line doesn't mean the same thing on an Earth hand as on a Water hand. Shape gives you the context; mounts and fingers, the character; lines, the details. If you respect this order, your readings will be far more coherent and far deeper. In this first part of the guide we'll work through the first two layers.

✦ THE ETHICS OF READING OTHER PEOPLE'S HANDS

When someone offers you their hand, they're also offering you their trust. And that deserves care. These are the rules I follow, and I invite you to make them your own:

- ✦ **Talk about possibilities, never certainties.** Use phrases like "you tend to", "you may" or "this suggests". Never "this is going to happen to you".
- ✦ **Don't frighten people.** If you see something that looks like a challenge, present it as an opportunity to grow, not as a threat.
- ✦ **Stay in your lane.** Don't talk about health, pregnancies, death or accidents. If the person asks, explain kindly that palmistry isn't meant for that and encourage them to see a professional.
- ✦ **Don't stand in for anyone.** A reading is no substitute for a doctor, a psychologist, a lawyer or a financial adviser.
- ✦ **Keep it confidential.** What's said during a reading stays there.
- ✦ **Respect boundaries.** If someone doesn't want to know something, or would rather stop, you stop.
- ✦ **Hand the power back.** End every reading by reminding the person that their life is in their own hands, in the most literal and most beautiful sense of the phrase.

With these foundations you have everything you need to take the first step. Take your hand, hold it up to the light and let's begin with the biggest, most obvious thing about it: its shape.



The shape of the hand

The four elements: Earth, Air, Fire and Water

The shape of your hand is the first impression, the overall landscape. Before you look at a single line, the proportion between palm and fingers already tells you a great deal about a person's underlying temperament. In modern palmistry this information is organised through the four classical elements: Earth, Air, Fire and Water. If you know a little astrology, they'll sound familiar; here they work in a similar way, as four broad styles of being in the world.

Remember that nobody is a pure element. What you'll usually find is one dominant type with touches of another. Take it as a starting point for getting to know yourself, never as a label that boxes you in.

♦ HOW TO MEASURE THE PALM

Look at the palm without the fingers: from the first crease at the wrist up to the base of the fingers, and from one side of the hand to the other, just below the knuckles.

- ♦ **Square palm:** the width and length are similar. It looks like a block and gives a feeling of solidity.
- ♦ **Rectangular or long palm:** it's clearly longer than it is wide. It gives a feeling of stretch, of height.

If you're unsure, grab a ruler or a strip of paper. Measure the width of the palm just below the fingers and compare it with the distance from the wrist crease to the base of the middle finger. If the two measurements are almost the same, the palm is square; if the length is clearly greater than the width, it's rectangular.

♦ HOW TO MEASURE THE FINGERS

Now compare the fingers with the palm. Your reference finger is the middle one.

- ♦ **Long fingers:** the middle finger is almost as long as the palm, around seven-eighths of it or more. At a glance, the fingers seem to take centre stage.
- ♦ **Short fingers:** the middle finger is clearly shorter than the palm, around three-quarters of it or even less. At a glance, the palm takes centre stage.

My tip.

Don't get hung up on millimetres. Very often your first impression, looking at the open hand from a little distance, is the most accurate. Ask yourself: does this hand look sturdy or slender? Do the fingers dominate, or does the palm?

With these two observations you can already place any hand in one of the four elements:

PALM	FINGERS	ELEMENT	KEYWORD
Square	Short	Earth	Doing
Square	Long	Air	Thinking
Long	Short	Fire	Acting
Long	Long	Water	Feeling



✦ THE EARTH HAND

EARTH HAND

How to recognise it: square palm and short fingers. It tends to be a firm, sturdy-looking hand, with slightly thicker skin and few lines, though they're clearly marked.

Personality. The Earth hand belongs to practical, steady people with both feet firmly on the ground. They like what's concrete, what can be touched, measured and checked. They're dependable: if they say they'll do something, they do it. They enjoy nature, routines that give them security and simple pleasures, like a good meal shared with others or an unhurried walk.

In love. They love through actions more than words. They're rarely ones for grand declarations, but they'll be there when you need them. They take a while to open up, because they need to feel stable, and once they commit they're loyal and protective. They value physical touch, calm and everyday gestures.

At work. They shine in tasks that produce tangible results: crafts and trades, cooking, gardening, building, organising, managing teams or any job that calls for patience and method. They're the quiet pillar that holds many projects up.

Their challenge. Learning to open up to change. The security they value so much can turn into rigidity or stubbornness, and sometimes they find it hard to say what they feel. Their growth lies in becoming more flexible and in putting words to their emotions.



♦ THE AIR HAND

AIR HAND

How to recognise it: square palm and long fingers. The hand looks balanced and nimble, with fingers that move a lot when the person talks. The lines are usually clear and fine, and moderate in number.

Personality. Air people live in the world of ideas. They're curious, communicative, logical and sociable. They need constant mental stimulation: learning, talking, reading, debating. They find it easy to analyse situations from the outside and usually have a quick, witty sense of humour.

In love. For them, closeness begins in the mind. They need a partner they can talk to for hours, someone who is also a friend. They value their freedom and their space very highly. Sometimes they rationalise what they feel instead of living it, and that can puzzle more emotional partners.

At work. They stand out in communication, teaching, writing, journalism, technology, sales or any field that involves connecting ideas and people. They're motivated by dynamic, varied environments.

Their challenge. Coming down from the head into the body and the heart. They tend to overthink things and can feel restless when their mind won't switch off. Their growth lies in connecting with their emotions and making room for moments of calm and silence.



✦ THE FIRE HAND

FIRE HAND

How to recognise it: long palm and short fingers. It's usually warm to the touch, with lots of lively, well-marked lines that seem full of movement.

Personality. Fire people are pure enthusiasm. Energetic, passionate, spontaneous and creative, they'd rather act than wait. They have a natural charisma that rubs off on others, and they love starting new projects. Their intuition is quick and they trust their gut.

In love. They love with intensity and generosity. They enjoy the chase, surprises and shared adventures. They're warm and expressive, though they can get bored if the relationship slips into routine. They need a partner who can keep up with them or, at the very least, won't try to dampen their spark.

At work. They're in their element in entrepreneurship, sales, the performing arts, sport, leading teams or any project that calls for initiative and movement. They're engines capable of pulling others along.

Their challenge. Patience and staying power. They start out with tremendous force, but sometimes struggle to finish what they begin. They also tend to give everything without holding back, so their growth lies in learning to pace their energy, to listen before reacting and to respect their need for rest.



✦ THE WATER HAND

WATER HAND

How to recognise it: long palm and long fingers. It's a slender hand, often delicate and fine-skinned, with many soft lines that form a kind of web.

Personality. Water people are sensitive, intuitive, imaginative and deeply empathetic. They pick up on what others feel almost without the need for words. They have a rich inner world, full of images, dreams and emotions, and they're often drawn to art, beauty and the spiritual.

In love. They're romantic and devoted. They look for a deep connection, almost a meeting of souls, and can idealise the person they love. They offer tenderness and understanding, although sometimes they absorb their partner's emotions as if they were their own.

At work. They find their place in the arts, music, design, creative writing, caring and support professions or any work where sensitivity is an asset. They do their best work in harmonious, gentle environments.

Their challenge. Setting boundaries. Their great sensitivity can leave them swept along by their own moods and other people's. Their growth lies in learning to protect themselves, to look after their energy and to bring their dreams down to earth, one step at a time.

✦ BEYOND SHAPE: TEXTURE, CONSISTENCY, FLEXIBILITY AND COLOUR

Once you've identified the element, these four details will help you refine it. Observe them gently, and never force the hand.

Skin texture. Run your fingertips over the back of the hand. Fine, soft skin is associated with sensitivity, refinement and receptiveness. Thicker or rougher skin speaks of resilience, practicality and a liking for the direct approach. Bear in mind that climate, manual work and skincare make a big difference, so ask before drawing conclusions.

Consistency. Gently press the centre of the palm. A firm hand that springs back straight away suggests practical energy, steadiness and a capacity for action. A soft hand points to someone who puts comfort, calm and the world of imagination first. At the extremes, a very hard hand can speak of rigidity, and a very soft one of a certain tendency to leave things until tomorrow.

Flexibility. Ask the person to bend their fingers back gently, without forcing them. A flexible hand reflects an open, adaptable mind, someone who adjusts easily to new things. A stiff hand speaks of steadiness, caution and loyalty to one's own ideas. Flexibility also depends on physical factors, so treat it only as a nuance and never insist if the person feels any discomfort.

Colour. Traditionally, the tone of the palm has been linked to temperament: a pinkish palm suggests warmth and balance; a paler one, reserve and introspection; a redder one, intensity and passion. Always compare the palm with the person's own skin tone, never with some ideal model.

Keeping our feet on the ground.

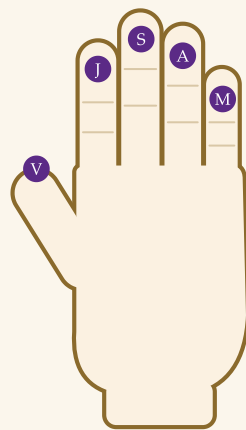
The colour and temperature of a hand change with cold, heat, exercise, nerves or the time of day. That's why, in this guide, colour is only a nuance of character and never a sign of health. If you're ever worried about something to do with your body, always see a healthcare professional.

Before moving on to the next chapter, here's a small exercise for you: look at both your hands, decide which element dominates in each one and write down three words that describe you according to that element. Then ask yourself honestly whether you recognise yourself in them. That question is where palmistry truly begins.



The fingers and the thumb

Five planets at your fingertips



If the shape of the hand is the landscape, the fingers are the paths leading out of it into the world. We use them to point, create, caress, write and express ourselves. No wonder tradition has given them so much importance.

In palmistry, each finger is linked to a planet and to the archetype that planet represents. In the drawing you'll see a letter above each one: **J** for Jupiter (index finger), **S** for Saturn (middle finger), **A** for Apollo or the Sun (ring finger), **M** for Mercury (little finger) and **V** for Venus and willpower (thumb).

FINGER	PLANET	MAIN THEMES
Index (J)	Jupiter	Self-esteem, ambition, leadership
Middle (S)	Saturn	Responsibility, structure, reflection
Ring (A)	Apollo or the Sun	Creativity, self-expression, joy
Little (M)	Mercury	Communication, wit, exchange
Thumb (V)	Venus and willpower	Willpower, logic, determination

To judge whether a finger is long or short, compare it with its neighbours. As a general guide, the index and ring fingers usually reach roughly halfway up the top phalanx of the middle finger, and the little finger reaches more or less the crease between the top and middle phalanges of the ring

finger. If a finger clearly goes past those marks, it's long; if it falls short of them, it's short. Notice, too, whether it's straight or leans towards another finger: a leaning finger seems to "lend" its energy to its neighbour, or to look to it for support.

✦ THE INDEX FINGER: JUPITER

INDEX (J)

It represents how you see yourself, your ambition, your sense of justice and the way you claim your place in the world.

Long: confidence, a desire to lead and healthy ambition. If it's very long, there may be a tendency to always want the last word. **Short:** discretion, a preference for staying in the background and, at times, doubts about one's own worth that are worth working on. **Straight:** stable, consistent self-esteem. **Leaning towards the middle finger:** ambition is put at the service of security and duty; sometimes it shows a person who looks for backing before taking the plunge.

✦ THE MIDDLE FINGER: SATURN

MIDDLE (S)

This is the finger of balance, responsibility, limits and our relationship with time and rules. Because it sits in the centre, it acts as the axis of the hand.

Long: seriousness, depth, a love of study and of time alone. **Short:** spontaneity and a certain carefree attitude towards rules. **Straight:** a good balance between duty and enjoyment. **Leaning towards the ring finger:** the sense of duty gives way to the wish to enjoy and create. **Leaning towards the index finger:** responsibility is tied to personal goals and ambition.

✦ THE RING FINGER: APOLLO OR THE SUN

RING (A)

It speaks of creativity, a love of beauty, the joy of living and the desire to shine and express yourself just as you are.

Long: an artistic soul, charisma and a certain taste for risk and recognition. **Short:** a low-key profile, with creativity that's more practical than showy. **Straight:** natural, uninhibited self-expression. **Leaning towards the middle finger:** a tendency to put creativity on the back burner because of obligations; an invitation to reclaim time for enjoyment.

✦ THE LITTLE FINGER: MERCURY

LITTLE (M)

This is the finger of communication, wit, the trading of ideas and the ability to connect with others through words.

Long: eloquence, persuasiveness and a knack for negotiating. **Short:** the person finds it hard to put feelings into words and expresses themselves better through actions. **Straight:** honest, direct communication. **Leaning towards the ring finger:** diplomacy and a talent for saying the right thing at the right moment. **Set well apart from the ring finger:** independence and a need to think for oneself. If the little finger starts lower down than the others, it's usually read as the mark of someone who is learning to value their own voice.

✦ INDEX VERSUS RING FINGER: A CLASSIC DUEL

One of the most revealing comparisons is between the index and ring fingers. Hold your hand straight, fingers together, and see which one reaches higher.

- ✦ **Index longer than ring finger:** confidence in your own opinion, a wish for control, caution and a love of organising. You prefer to play it safe.
- ✦ **Ring finger longer than index:** creativity, intuition, a taste for adventure and charisma. You're drawn to challenges and personal gambles.
- ✦ **Both the same:** a balance between security and expression, between the head and the creative impulse.

✦ THE THREE PHALANGES

Each finger (except the thumb, which we'll look at separately) has three phalanges, and each one represents a world of its own:

- ✦ **Top phalanx (the one with the nail):** the mental and spiritual world. Ideas, intuition, ideals.
- ✦ **Middle phalanx:** the practical world. Organisation, method, the ability to turn ideas into action.
- ✦ **Bottom phalanx (at the base):** the material world. Comfort, pleasures, enjoyment of the senses.

Notice which one is longest or thickest on most of the fingers: it will show you which world the person feels most at home in. A thick, fleshy bottom phalanx speaks of someone who enjoys good food and creature comforts; if it's narrow, with a "waist", it suggests a selective person with high standards about their surroundings.

✦ THE KNUCKLES: SMOOTH OR KNOTTY FINGERS

Look at the fingers from the side. If the joints barely show, we're talking about **smooth fingers:** intuitive, quick people who go by first impressions and grasp things in a flash. If the joints are clearly defined, they're **knotty fingers:** analytical people who examine, question and need to

understand the why before they act. It's as if each knuckle were a little filter that thoughts have to pass through.

Bear in mind.

With age, manual work or certain physical circumstances, the joints can change. Palmistry doesn't interpret those changes. If someone notices discomfort or changes in their hands, that's a matter for a healthcare professional.

✦ THE FINGERTIPS

The shape of the tip adds nuance to the character of each finger. You'll usually find a mix, but one style almost always dominates.

TIP	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT SUGGESTS
Square	Straight at the end, with defined corners	Order, method, practicality, a liking for clear rules
Conic	Rounded and soft	Sensitivity, an eye for beauty, intuition, adaptability
Spatulate	Widens towards the tip	Action, originality, inventiveness, a need for movement
Pointed	Narrows almost to a point	Idealism, imagination, spirituality, receptiveness

✦ HOW THE FINGERS ARE SPACED

Ask the person to open their hand naturally, without thinking about it, as if they were showing it to you. The way the fingers spread says a lot about their attitude to life.

- ✦ **Fingers spread wide:** independence, openness and a free spirit.
- ✦ **Fingers held together:** reserve, caution and a certain need to protect oneself.
- ✦ **Wide gap between index and middle finger:** independent thinking; the person forms their own opinions.
- ✦ **Wide gap between middle and ring finger:** a tendency to live in the present and not plan too much.
- ✦ **Wide gap between ring and little finger:** independence in action and a need for personal space.

✦ THE THUMB IN DETAIL

The thumb is the most special finger on the hand. It's what lets us grip, hold and build, and that's why palmistry sees it as the great symbol of willpower. It's linked to Venus because its base forms the mount of Venus, which we'll talk about in the next chapter.

Size. With the thumb held against the hand, see how far up it reaches. If it gets to roughly halfway up the bottom phalanx of the index finger, it's medium-sized. A large thumb speaks of willpower, determination and the ability to steer one's own life. A small thumb suggests someone more sensitive to their surroundings, who goes with the flow easily and can strengthen their will through small daily commitments.

Angle of opening. Ask the person to open the thumb as far as it will go without effort, and look at the angle it makes with the index finger.

- ✦ **Less than 45 degrees:** reserve, caution and attachment to the familiar.
- ✦ **Between 45 and 90 degrees:** a balance between openness and caution; this is the most common.
- ✦ **Around 90 degrees or more:** great independence, generosity and an adventurous spirit, sometimes with a touch of impulsiveness.

Flexibility. Gently press the tip of the thumb backwards. If it bends easily, the person is adaptable, generous and open to negotiation, although they may spread their energy across too many fronts. If it stays stiff, it shows firmness, steadiness and a will that doesn't bend easily, with the risk of tipping into stubbornness.

The phalanges of the thumb. The first, the one with the nail, is the phalanx of **will**: your ability to decide and take action. The second is the phalanx of **logic**: your ability to reason and plan. Compare them:

- ✦ **Will longer than logic:** you act first and think later. Plenty of get-up-and-go.
- ✦ **Logic longer than will:** you think everything through carefully before taking a step, sometimes so carefully that the step gets delayed.
- ✦ **Both similar:** a good balance between reflection and action.

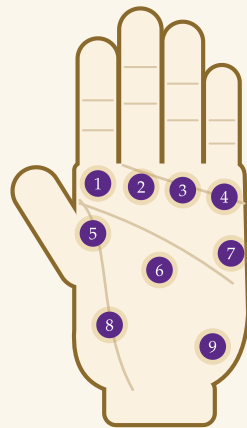
Notice the shape of the logic phalanx too. If it's narrow in the middle, with a "waist", it suggests tact and diplomacy. If it's broad and straight, it speaks of someone direct, who says things exactly as they think them.

As an exercise, look at your five fingers one by one now and choose the one that seems strongest on your hand. That finger is pointing, quite literally, to one of your great strengths.



The mounts of the hand

The hills that hold your energy



If you run your fingertips over your palm, you'll notice it isn't flat: it has little hills and valleys. These are the mounts, pads of tissue that palmistry reads as stores of energy. A well-developed mount shows that a particular quality is active in your life; a flat one, that this energy is quieter or waiting to be cultivated.

To see them properly, ask for the hand to be cupped slightly, as if holding a small ball, and use side lighting that casts soft shadows. Then touch them gently to feel whether they're firm or soft.

In the drawing you'll see each mount marked with a number:

- ① **Jupiter**, below the index finger.
- ② **Saturn**, below the middle finger.
- ③ **Apollo**, below the ring finger.
- ④ **Mercury**, below the little finger.
- ⑤ **Inner Mars (Mars positive)**, on the inside of the hand, next to the thumb.
- ⑥ **Plain of Mars**, in the centre of the palm.
- ⑦ **Outer Mars (Mars negative)**, on the outer edge of the hand.
- ⑧ **Venus**, at the base of the thumb.
- ⑨ **Moon (Luna)**, at the base of the palm, on the side opposite the thumb.

✦ THREE KEYS BEFORE YOU START

Mounts are subtler than lines, so at first you may find them hard to tell apart. That's normal. These three keys will help you sharpen your eye:

- ✦ **Height.** Does the mount stand out clearly, barely hint at itself, or not show at all? Always compare it with the rest of the same hand, never with someone else's.
- ✦ **Firmness.** A firm mount shows energy that's active and available. A soft one suggests the quality is there but expresses itself in a more relaxed or on-and-off way.
- ✦ **Position.** Notice whether the mount sits centred under its finger or drifts to one side. Later on you'll see that these shifts add some very interesting nuances.

Be patient with yourself. The first few times you may only make out two or three mounts clearly. With practice, your fingers will learn to read those little rises almost without you noticing.

✦ 1. MOUNT OF JUPITER

JUPITER

Where it is: just below the index finger. **What it represents:** ambition, self-esteem, leadership, ideals and a sense of justice.

Well developed: self-confidence, generosity, the ability to inspire others and a desire to grow. **Flat or faint:** a preference for following rather than leading, modesty and, at times, self-esteem that could use some care. **Overdeveloped:** pride, a need for recognition and a tendency to impose one's own views.

✦ 2. MOUNT OF SATURN

SATURN

Where it is: below the middle finger. **What it represents:** responsibility, introspection, the wisdom that comes with experience and the need for structure.

Well developed: good sense, caution, a love of study and deep reflection. **Flat or faint:** this is the most common, and it speaks of an uncomplicated person who doesn't overcomplicate life, though they may sometimes struggle to get organised. **Overdeveloped:** a tendency towards melancholy, isolation or always seeing the more serious side of things.

✦ 3. MOUNT OF APOLLO

APOLLO

Where it is: below the ring finger. **What it represents:** creativity, joy, an eye for beauty and personal fulfilment.

Well developed: optimism, charisma, good taste and an ease in enjoying beauty in all its forms. **Flat or faint:** a practically minded life, with little interest in aesthetics or in standing out. **Overdeveloped:** vanity, a constant need for applause and a desire to shine at any cost.

✦ 4. MOUNT OF MERCURY

MERCURY

Where it is: below the little finger. **What it represents:** communication, wit, mental agility, exchange and adaptability.

Well developed: eloquence, a sense of humour, a talent for negotiating and learning quickly. **Flat or faint:** shyness when expressing oneself and a preference for listening rather than talking. **Overdeveloped:** a tendency to talk too much, or to use words to win people over at any price.

✦ 5. INNER MARS (MARS POSITIVE)

MARS POSITIVE

Where it is: on the inside of the hand, next to the thumb, between the base of the index finger and the mount of Venus. **What it represents:** active courage, initiative and the ability to stand up for yourself and for what you love.

Well developed: bravery, determination and the energy to take on challenges. **Flat or faint:** a tendency to avoid conflict and to stay quiet so as not to rock the boat. **Overdeveloped:** impulsiveness, a quick temper and a readiness to get into arguments.

✦ 6. PLAIN OF MARS

PLAIN OF MARS

Where it is: in the centre of the palm, surrounded by all the other mounts. More than a mount, it's a small valley. **What it represents:** the balance between your forces, the way you handle inner tension and your composure in the face of the unexpected.

Well developed (firm, neither sunken nor bulging): serenity and a good ability to stay centred. **Sunken or faint:** a tendency to feel overwhelmed by circumstances; an invitation to look after your rest and recharge your energy. **Overdeveloped (raised or very fleshy):** a combative temperament and little patience when things don't go as expected.

✦ 7. OUTER MARS (MARS NEGATIVE)

MARS NEGATIVE

Where it is: on the outer edge of the palm, between the mount of Mercury and the mount of the Moon. **What it represents:** resilience, perseverance and the quiet courage of someone who knows how to hold on.

Well developed: tenacity, calm under pressure and an ability not to give up. **Flat or faint:** a tendency to give up when things get complicated. **Overdeveloped:** stubbornness, difficulty giving ground and a tendency to hold grudges.

✦ 8. MOUNT OF VENUS

VENUS

Where it is: at the base of the thumb, the fleshy area enclosed by the Life line. **What it represents:** love, affection, sensuality, the joy of living and the energy you pour into the things you enjoy.

Well developed: warmth, affection, passion, vitality and a great love of life, music and contact with others. **Flat or faint:** emotional reserve and a calmer energy; the invitation is to cultivate pleasure, play and the habits that recharge you. **Overdeveloped:** a tendency towards excess, seeking pleasure without limits or experiencing love possessively.

✦ 9. MOUNT OF THE MOON (LUNA)

MOON

Where it is: at the base of the palm, on the side opposite the thumb. **What it represents:** imagination, intuition, the world of dreams, sensitivity and the desire to explore.

Well developed: a rich imagination, fine-tuned intuition, creative talent and a love of travel and the unknown. **Flat or faint:** a realistic, practical mindset, not much given to fantasy. **Overdeveloped:** a tendency to get lost in daydreams, to idealise or to be carried away by changing moods.

Remember.

Mounts speak of energy and character, never of health. A flat mount doesn't mean you're missing anything; it means that quality expresses itself more quietly, and you can cultivate it if you wish.

✦ HOW TO COMPARE THE MOUNTS AND FIND THE DOMINANT ONE

Reading a single mount is useful, but the magic happens when you compare them with one another. I suggest you follow these steps:

- 1 **Look at the hand as a whole.** Before touching, use side lighting to see which area of the palm catches your eye most. Very often the dominant mount jumps right out at you.
- 2 **Touch them one by one.** Go over the mounts with the pad of your thumb and compare their height and firmness. The highest and firmest is usually the dominant one.
- 3 **Watch for shifts.** Sometimes a mount isn't directly under its finger but leans towards its neighbour. In that case, it borrows some of that neighbour's qualities. For example, a mount of Jupiter shifted towards Saturn suggests an ambition that becomes more thoughtful and responsible.
- 4 **Look for pairs.** It's common for two mounts to stand out together. Their combination tells a richer story than either one alone.
- 5 **Connect it with the element.** A prominent mount of the Moon on a Water hand reinforces sensitivity; on an Earth hand, it adds an imaginative touch to a very practical person.

Some common combinations to inspire you:

PROMINENT MOUNTS	POSSIBLE READING
Jupiter and Apollo	Charismatic leadership; someone who inspires others and enjoys being in the spotlight
Venus and Moon	Great artistic sensitivity, imagination and emotional warmth
Mercury and Mars positive	Courageous communication, a talent for defending ideas with words
Saturn and Moon	A deep inner world, a love of introspection and the mysterious
Mars negative and Jupiter	Ambition with staying power; long-term goals

If no mount stands out and they all seem in harmony, you're looking at a balanced hand, belonging to someone who spreads their energy fairly evenly across the different areas of their life. And if you notice that several mounts are flat, don't worry: it usually points to an uncomplicated person focused on what really matters.

As always, keep whatever helps you know yourself better. Mounts aren't a destiny written in your skin, but a map of your energies at this moment. And maps, as you know, are there to help you choose a path, not to force you down just one.

My exercise for you.

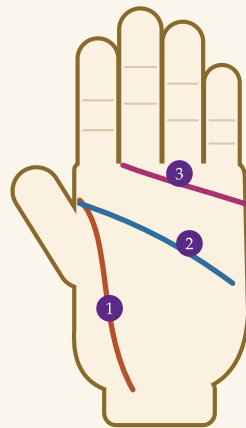
For one week, look at your mounts every morning in the same light. Note which one seems most prominent and which the most discreet, and write a sentence about how that shows up in your life. Then choose the flattest mount and find a small daily action to feed its energy: an honest conversation for Mercury, some time drawing or playing music for Apollo, a moment of silence for Saturn. It's not about changing your hand, but about awakening qualities you already carry inside.

With this chapter you complete the first two layers of a reading: shape, fingers and mounts. You now know how to look at a hand as a complete landscape. In the next part of the guide we'll dive into the lines, and you'll see how everything you've learned so far brings them to life.



The three main lines

Life, Head and Heart



The moment almost everyone is waiting for when they first come to palmistry has arrived: looking at the lines. So far we've learned to read the shape of the hand, the fingers and the mounts, and all of that still matters, because a line is never read on its own. But the lines are, so to speak, the most visible handwriting on your palm, so it's only natural that they spark so much curiosity.

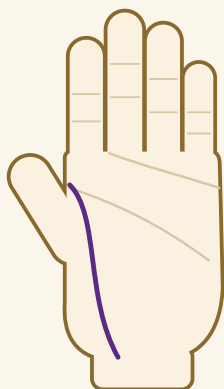
In the figure you'll find the three major lines numbered. Number **1** is the **Life line**, which curves around the base of the thumb. Number **2** is the **Head line**, which crosses the palm more or less through the middle. Number **3** is the **Heart line**, the highest of the three, running just below the fingers. Almost everyone has them, though in very different forms, which is why they're the best place to start practising.

Before we begin, I'd like you to hold on to one idea that will stay with you throughout this chapter: lines are not verdicts. They're living creases that change over the years, becoming more or less marked depending on how we use our hands and the stage of life we're going through. In this guide we read them as a mirror of who you are, your tendencies and your inner resources, never as a destiny set in stone. You always have the final say over your path.

How to look.

Find soft, natural light, relax your hand without stretching it out completely and look at it from a distance first, the way you'd take in a landscape. Then move closer. Always compare your dominant hand, the one you use most, which speaks of how you express yourself today, with the other one, which usually shows your underlying temperament.

✦ THE LIFE LINE



The Life line starts at the edge of the palm, between the thumb and the index finger, and sweeps down in an arc around the mount of Venus, that fleshy area at the base of the thumb. It usually ends near the wrist, although sometimes it stops sooner or veers off towards the centre of the palm.

Let's start with the most important point, because it's the myth that causes the most fear: **a short Life line does not mean a short life.** It doesn't mean that at all. The length of this line has nothing to do with how many years you'll live, and nobody, not with a hand or with any other tool, can know such a thing. There are very long-lived people with short lines and young people with extremely long ones. If someone has ever frightened you with this, you can put that weight down right now.

So what does it represent? The way I read it, the Life line speaks of your **vitality**, how you manage your energy, how rooted you are and your relationship with the world closest to you: your home, your routines, your way of being in the physical world. It also reflects the big changes of pace, those moments when the way you live is transformed.

✦ LONG OR SHORT

A long line flowing calmly down to the wrist usually describes someone with a steady rhythm, who enjoys continuity and long-term projects. A shorter line that stops halfway speaks of energy that comes in bursts, of someone who prefers a change of scene and who often finds their strength in other parts of the hand, such as a strong Fate line. Remember: this is about your style of energy, not about length of life.

✦ DEEP OR FINE

When the line is deep and well defined, the person usually has energy that's readily available and resilient, with the stamina to keep up an effort. If it's fine or faint, the energy is more delicate and

selective: it achieves a lot when motivated, but needs breaks and gentle surroundings. Neither is better than the other; they simply call for different kinds of care.

✦ WIDE OR TIGHT CURVE

Notice how far the line swings away from the thumb. If it traces a wide curve that reaches out into the palm, the mount of Venus is generous, and that usually points to warmth, sociability, a desire to experience things and a big appetite for life. If the line hugs the thumb closely, the person tends to be more reserved and careful with their energy, and usually prefers fewer plans, but well-chosen ones.

✦ WHERE IT STARTS AND WHERE IT ENDS

If it starts high up, near the mount of Jupiter below the index finger, there's often ambition and a wish to take charge of one's own life from very early on. If it starts lower, closer to the thumb, the person takes their time to get going and values security.

At its end, if the line closes in around the thumb towards the wrist, it shows a strong attachment to home, roots and the familiar. If instead it opens out and ends towards the mount of the Moon, on the opposite side of the palm, it reveals a restless spirit, eager to travel, change surroundings or live far from where they started. Sometimes the line splits at the end with one branch heading each way: it's the portrait of someone who lives between two worlds, torn between the nest and the horizon.

✦ BRANCHES RISING OR FALLING

The little lines that leave the Life line and rise towards the fingers are read as drives to better yourself: efforts, personal goals, moments when you decided to grow. If a branch clearly rises towards the index finger, it usually speaks of ambition; if it heads towards the middle finger, of a commitment to something serious and lasting.

Branches that fall downwards speak instead of times when your energy scattered or you needed to draw back. They aren't bad news: they're reminders that every cycle has its resting phase.

✦ BREAKS

A break is a point where the line is interrupted. In this guide we understand it as a **change of direction**: a move, a change of lifestyle, a stage when you reinvented yourself. If the two sections overlap, that is, if the new line starts before the old one ends, the transition is usually gradual and well supported. If there's a small square around the break, it's read as protection and the resources to come through the change calmly.

✦ ISLANDS

An island is a small oval formed when the line splits and then rejoins. It represents a period of **tiredness or divided energy**, a time when you were juggling too many things at once or had to learn to stop. It's an invitation to look at your pace, to delegate and to take care of yourself. If

you're worried about anything to do with your wellbeing, that's not something a hand can answer: that's what healthcare professionals are for, and turning to them is always the right decision.

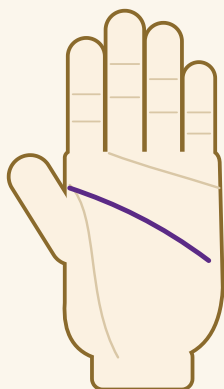
✦ CHAINS

When the line looks as if it's made of small links, we call it a chain. It usually describes fluctuating energy with ups and downs, typical of people who are very sensitive to their surroundings. Routine, regular rest and quiet spaces suit them well.

✦ THE DOUBLE LINE

Sometimes a second line appears running parallel on the inside, over the mount of Venus. Traditionally it's called the sister line or the line of Mars. It's a lovely sign: it points to reserves of inner strength, support from the people close to you or a rich inner life that holds you up when things take effort.

✦ THE HEAD LINE



The Head line usually starts at the same point as the Life line, between the thumb and the index finger, or very close to it. From there it crosses the palm towards the outer edge of the hand, the side below the little finger. It may end halfway across the palm, reach all the way to outer Mars on the outer edge, or slope gently down towards the mount of the Moon.

This line speaks of your **way of thinking**: how you process information, how you make decisions, what helps you focus and what distracts you, whether you reason things through step by step or grasp them in a flash. Mind you, it doesn't measure intelligence. It measures your mental style, and every style has its own gifts.

✦ LONG OR SHORT

A long line describes a mind that enjoys analysing, that weighs up many possibilities before deciding and takes an interest in a wide range of subjects. A short line points to direct, practical thinking, focused on the essentials. People with a short Head line tend to be quick at solving problems and not fond of beating about the bush.

✦ DEEP OR FINE

A deep line reflects an ability to concentrate and a mind that holds on to its goals. A fine line speaks of nimble, sensitive thinking that picks up on nuances but can tire more easily if pushed too hard. In that case, breaks and a tidy environment are great allies.

✦ JOINED TO OR SEPARATE FROM THE LIFE LINE AT THE START

This is one of the most revealing details on the whole hand. If the Head line starts tied to the Life line and the two share an opening stretch, the person is usually cautious and thoughtful, the kind who thinks before acting. They have often taken their family's or their circle's opinion into account when making important decisions, and their independence may have come gradually.

When the shared stretch is very long, there may be a certain tendency towards insecurity or a need for approval before taking the plunge. It's something that can be worked on with confidence and practice.

If the two lines start apart, with a small gap between them, we find someone independent, with initiative, who trusts their own judgement and isn't afraid of getting things wrong. The wider the gap, the more daring and impulsiveness. These are people who jump in and learn as they go.

✦ STRAIGHT OR SLOPING TOWARDS THE MOON

A straight Head line that crosses the palm almost horizontally describes logical, orderly and realistic thinking. It likes facts, plans and things that work. It's the line of someone who organises, calculates and keeps their feet on the ground.

If the line curves and slopes down towards the mount of the Moon, imagination takes centre stage. These are creative, intuitive minds that think in pictures and stories, with a very rich inner world. The steeper the slope, the stronger that artistic or dreamy streak. As so often, the ideal lies in balance: a gentle curve combines practicality with imagination.

✦ THE WRITER'S FORK

When the Head line splits at the end into two branches, one carrying on straight and the other sloping down towards the Moon, we call it the **writer's fork**. It shows the ability to see things from two angles, to combine logic with creativity and to express ideas in an original way. You don't have to write books to have one: it appears in people who communicate well, who know how to tell a story, who find unexpected solutions or who feel at home in mixed fields such as design, teaching or communication.

✦ BRANCHES, BREAKS, ISLANDS AND CHAINS

Branches rising from the Head line point to ideas that flourish, intellectual projects or moments of clarity. If a branch rises towards the mount of Mercury, below the little finger, it's usually associated with a talent for business or communication; if it rises towards Apollo, below the ring

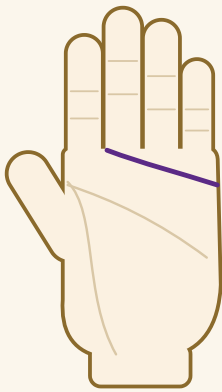
finger, with creativity that gets recognised. Falling branches reflect doubts or periods of mental scatter.

A break in this line shows a **change in the way you think**: a shift in your interests, a change of studies or career, a new way of seeing the world after a meaningful experience. Islands speak of periods of mental overload, when your head won't stop and it's hard to concentrate; they call for rest and order. A chained line describes a restless mind that jumps from one idea to the next and benefits greatly from lists, routines and calm.

✦ THE DOUBLE HEAD LINE

It's rare, but it does exist: two parallel Head lines. It usually describes people with great mental capacity, who can lead two intellectual lives at once, for example a technical profession and an intense creative hobby, or who have a remarkable knack for seeing both sides of every question.

✦ THE HEART LINE



The Heart line is the highest of the three. It starts at the outer edge of the hand, below the little finger, and runs towards the thumb side, passing beneath the mounts of Mercury, Apollo and Saturn. Where it ends is one of the most interesting things to read, because it can finish in very different places.

This line speaks of your **emotional world**: how you feel, how you show affection, what you expect from your bonds and how you experience friendship, love and intimacy. It doesn't predict who you'll be with or when: it describes the way you love.

✦ WHERE IT ENDS

END OF THE LINE	WHAT IT USUALLY SHOWS
Below the mount of Jupiter (index finger)	High ideals in love, loyalty, generosity. Looks for someone to admire and can set demanding expectations for themselves.
Between Jupiter and Saturn	A balance between emotion and practicality. Warm but realistic affection, able to commit without losing oneself.
Below the mount of Saturn (middle finger)	More reserved affection, or affection focused on the concrete. Shows love through actions more than words and needs their own space.

If the line curves at the end and rises towards the fingers, the person expresses their feelings easily and is warm, spontaneous and physical in showing affection. If the line is straight and ends without curving, emotion is lived in a more inward, mental way: they feel a great deal, but process it before showing it.

✦ LONG OR SHORT, DEEP OR FINE

A long Heart line that crosses almost the whole palm describes someone deeply devoted to their relationships, giving and with a great capacity for empathy. A short line speaks of someone more emotionally independent, who values their freedom and chooses carefully whom they let into their world.

A deep line points to intense, stable emotions. A fine line reflects sensitivity, gentleness and, at times, a certain vulnerability to conflict; these are people who need to feel safe before they open up.

✦ BRANCHES, BREAKS, ISLANDS AND CHAINS

Branches rising from the Heart line are read as emotional experiences that helped you grow: meaningful friendships, hopes, moments of shared joy. Those that drop towards the Head line speak of times when reason weighed more than feeling, or of disagreements you learned from.

A break in this line shows a **change in the way you experience affection**: a before and after in the way you love, perhaps following a period of reflection or personal growth. Islands represent periods of emotional tiredness, when you gave more than you received or needed to rearrange your priorities. A chained line describes a very lively sensitivity, someone who falls in love with people, causes and places, and whose challenge is to look after their own balance.

✦ THE DOUBLE HEART LINE

A second line running parallel to the Heart line is a sign of a great reserve of affection and emotional protection. These are usually very loyal people, able to support others and who, in turn, can count on solid support themselves.

✦ THE SIMIAN LINE

On some hands, the Head line and the Heart line don't appear separately but are fused into a single line that crosses the palm from side to side. This is what tradition calls the **simian line**, although I prefer to call it the single line or the transverse line, because the classic name doesn't do it justice. It can appear on one hand or on both, and it's more common than people think.

Read with respect, the single line describes people in whom thought and emotion go hand in hand, with no separation. When something matters to them, they give themselves to it completely, heart and head at the same time. They usually have great powers of concentration, plenty of determination and an intensity that, well channelled, takes them a very long way. Their challenge is learning to pace that energy and allow themselves breaks, because doing things by

halves is hard for them. There's nothing to worry about if you have one: it's simply a particular, and very powerful, way of being in the world.

Before we move on.

None of these three lines is read in isolation. A Head line sloping towards the Moon doesn't mean the same thing on a firm, practical Earth hand as on a long, sensitive Water hand. Always combine what you see in the lines with what you already know about the shape of the hand, the fingers and the mounts. And, above all, remember that you're reading tendencies and possibilities, not a finished script.



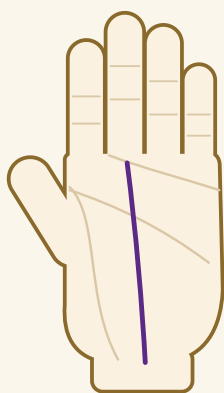
The minor lines

Fate, Sun, Mercury and other traces

Once you know the three major lines, the palm starts to reveal more subtle markings. These are the minor lines, and this brings me to one of the most important things I want to tell you in this chapter: **not everyone has them, and that's absolutely fine**. Some hands are full of fine lines and others are almost clear, with barely more than the three major ones. Both are equally valuable. Not having a minor line doesn't mean something is missing from your life; it simply shows that this energy finds expression through other parts of your hand or your character.

The minor lines are also the ones that change most over time. They can appear, lengthen, fade or become sharper within just a few years. That's why it's worth looking at them every so often, the way you might reread a diary.

♦ THE FATE LINE



The Fate line, also known as the line of Saturn, rises through the centre of the palm from the wrist area towards the middle finger, the finger of Saturn. It can be long and unbroken, begin halfway up the hand or appear only in the upper section.

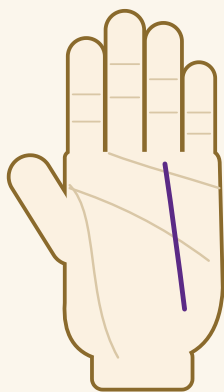
Despite its name, it doesn't speak of a fixed destiny. In this guide we read it as the line of your **sense of direction**: your calling, your relationship with work and responsibility, the feeling that your life is heading somewhere. It's the backbone of your projects.

- ♦ **Where it starts.** If it begins near the Life line or from inside it, your family background has strongly influenced your path. If it starts on the mount of the Moon, your direction has been shaped with the help of other people, the public or your own imagination. If it starts in the centre of the wrist, it suggests a clear sense of direction from very early on.

- ✦ **Where it becomes visible.** If it appears from the middle of the palm upwards, the sense of direction has often taken shape with maturity. Many people find their place later in life and enjoy it enormously.
- ✦ **Depth.** A strong line describes steadiness and commitment. A fine or broken line, a more flexible life, open to trying different paths.
- ✦ **Breaks and detours.** These point to changes in career or in life: a new job, a change of field, a brave decision. If the sections overlap, the change is usually well prepared.
- ✦ **Islands.** They speak of periods of tiredness or doubt about your direction, times to rethink your priorities.
- ✦ **Where it ends.** It usually finishes below the middle finger. If it veers towards the index finger at the end, your path leans towards leadership or ambitious goals; if it bends towards the ring finger, towards creativity and doing what you love. If it stops at the Heart line, your affections and the people you love weigh heavily in your decisions; if it stops at the Head line, you've chosen your direction with reason leading the way.
- ✦ **Double line.** Two parallel lines suggest two activities running side by side, such as a job and a personal calling, or a life with two centres of interest that sit happily together.

And what if you don't have a Fate line? That's very common. It usually describes people who prefer not to tie themselves to a single path, who improvise with flair and live freely. It never means a lack of success or purpose.

✦ THE SUN LINE OR APOLLO LINE



This line rises towards the ring finger, the finger of Apollo, running more or less parallel to the Fate line. It's usually shorter and often appears only in the upper part of the palm, between the Heart line and the base of the ring finger.

The Sun line speaks of **personal fulfilment**, creativity and the ability to shine doing what you love. It doesn't measure fame or money: it measures the joy you feel when you express yourself and the recognition you find, starting with your own.

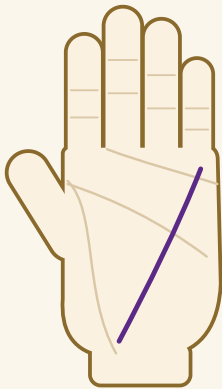
- ✦ **Long and clear:** creative talent and a knack for getting others to appreciate what you do.
- ✦ **Short, only below the ring finger:** fulfilment comes with time, often in later life, when you learn to enjoy what you've achieved.

- ✦ **Several small lines:** many creative interests at once; the challenge is choosing where to put your energy.
- ✦ **Starting on the mount of the Moon:** creativity fed by imagination and by contact with an audience.
- ✦ **Starting on the Head line:** achievements that come through intellectual effort and good ideas.

Look, too, at how it relates to the Fate line. When both are clear and run together, there's usually harmony between what you do and what you enjoy. When the Sun line is stronger than the Fate line, the person values fulfilment more than stability, and would rather follow a path that excites them, even if it's less predictable.

Many people don't have this line, and that doesn't mean they can't be creative or happy. It simply means their light doesn't depend on how others see them.

✦ THE MERCURY LINE



The Mercury line starts in the lower part of the palm, often near the Life line or the mount of the Moon, and rises diagonally towards the little finger, the finger of Mercury. It's a very variable line: it can be unbroken, fragmented, very faint or not there at all.

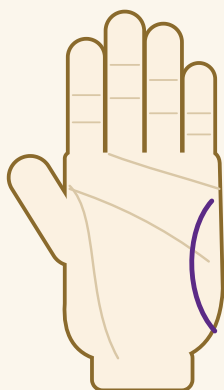
In old tradition it was called the "health line" or the "hepatic line". In this guide we don't read it that way, because a hand can't diagnose anything and I don't want anyone worrying about a crease. We understand it as the line of **communication, practical intuition** and **looking after your habits**: how easily you express yourself, negotiate and sense what a situation needs, and also your relationship with the routines that keep you going day to day.

- ✦ **Clear and unbroken:** good communication skills, a flair for business, languages or teaching, and fairly stable habits.
- ✦ **Fragmented:** a changeable communication style that works in phases. It may show that your routines suffer when there's a lot of stress, and that it helps you to look after your rest and keep some order.
- ✦ **Wavy:** a quick, nervous mind that needs to channel its energy through physical activity, creativity or conversation.
- ✦ **Absent:** this is very common and doesn't point to anything negative. This energy simply doesn't need a line of its own to express itself.

Important.

No line on the hand, this one included, says anything reliable about your health. If you notice any discomfort or have concerns about your wellbeing, always consult a healthcare professional. Palmistry can invite you to review your habits, but it is never a substitute for medical advice.

✦ THE INTUITION LINE

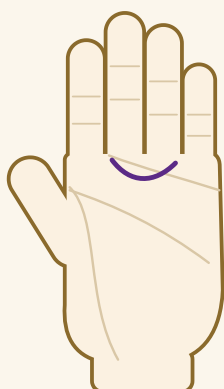


This is an uncommon and very special line. It traces an arc that starts on the mount of the Moon, in the lower part of the outer edge of the hand, and curves up towards the mount of Mercury, below the little finger. It looks like a crescent moon drawn along the edge of the palm.

It speaks of **well-developed intuition**: that ability to know things without knowing how you know them, to read the atmosphere of a room the moment you walk in, to sense what someone needs. People who have it often have vivid dreams, great empathy and a gift for art, therapy, supporting others or any work that calls for listening beyond words.

If it's clear and complete, that sensitivity is integrated and the person trusts it. If it's fragmented or only hinted at, the intuition is there but perhaps you don't yet dare to listen to it fully. Either way, it's a gift you can nurture with calm, attention and moments of silence. And if you don't have it, that doesn't mean you lack intuition: yours may show up in other features, such as a Head line sloping towards the Moon or a well-developed mount of the Moon.

✦ THE GIRDLE OF VENUS

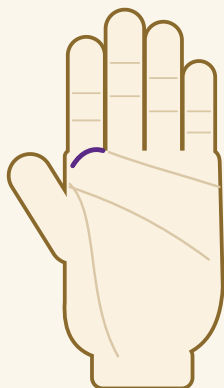


The Girdle of Venus is a semicircle drawn above the Heart line, usually from the gap between the index and middle fingers to the gap between the ring and little fingers. It therefore encircles the mounts of Saturn and Apollo. It often appears incomplete, in several segments.

It describes a **very finely tuned sensitivity**: people who are receptive to beauty, art, other people's emotions and the stimuli around them. They feel intensely, are easily moved and have a strong aesthetic sense. It's a beautiful energy, though it can sometimes overflow: if you recognise yourself here, you probably need calm spaces to recharge after noisy or emotionally charged environments.

When the girdle is fragmented, that sensitivity shows up at certain moments, depending on the context. When it's double or very strongly marked, emotional and imaginative life is especially rich, and creativity is its best outlet.

✦ THE RING OF SOLOMON

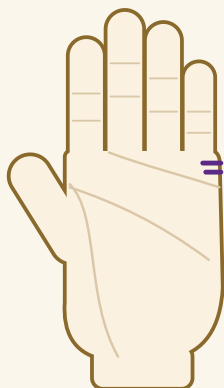


The Ring of Solomon is a small curved line that circles the base of the index finger, over the mount of Jupiter. Sometimes it's a complete arc, and sometimes barely a diagonal crossing the mount.

Traditionally it's associated with **wisdom** and a deep understanding of people. Those who have it are often the ones others turn to for advice, with a natural ability to grasp what makes each person tick. It's common in people with a calling to guide, teach, support or lead with empathy. It also points to an interest in deep questions: philosophy, spirituality, the meaning of things.

Don't confuse it with a line that crosses the mount of Jupiter without curving, which may simply be a branch of the Heart line. Take your time looking at it and compare both hands.

✦ RELATIONSHIP LINES, OR AFFECTION LINES



If you look at your hand from the side, along the edge below the little finger, between the base of the finger and the end of the Heart line, you'll probably see one or more short horizontal lines. These are the relationship lines, also called affection lines.

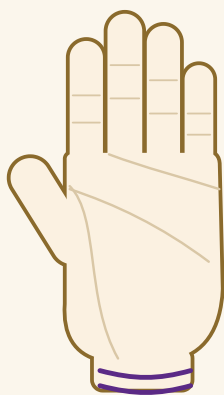
For a long time it was said that their number showed how many times someone would marry. In this guide we don't read them that way, and I invite you to leave that idea behind. These lines speak of the **important bonds** in your life: relationships that left their mark on you, whether romantic, deep friendships or a special connection with someone. They describe your ability to form meaningful ties and the imprint those ties leave on you.

- ✦ **One long, clear line:** a capacity for deep commitment and lasting bonds.
- ✦ **Several fine lines:** an emotional life rich in connections, with people who left their mark at different stages.
- ✦ **A line that rises at the end:** bonds that lift you up and help you grow.
- ✦ **A line that forks at the end:** a bond that changes over time, or one in which each person needs to keep their own space.
- ✦ **No clear lines:** emotional independence, or simply a way of loving that doesn't show up in this corner of the hand.

To see them properly, close your hand slightly and look at the edge in side lighting: that way you can tell them apart from the wrinkles that form when you bend the little finger. A true relationship line is usually sharper and runs a little way onto the palm.

None of this predicts who you'll be with, when or for how long. Your relationships depend on you, on the other person and on everything you build together.

✦ THE BRACELETS, OR RASCETTES



The bracelets, also called rascettes, are the lines that cross the wrist just below the palm. Most people have two or three, although there may be just one or more than three.

Some old traditions gave them meanings to do with years of life but, just as with the Life line, that reading has no basis whatsoever and we don't use it here. We read them as the **foundation** of the hand: your base, your stability and the connection between what you think and what you do.

- ✦ **Clear, parallel bracelets:** a sense of balance, a solid personal base and an ease in keeping your feet on the ground.
- ✦ **The first one curving up towards the palm:** a tendency to take on too much and forget about yourself; a reminder to look after your pace.
- ✦ **Chained or blurred bracelets:** periods when the effort was great and you found it hard to feel settled; they invite you to build routines that ground you.

- ★ **Lines rising from the bracelets:** a wish to travel, to expand or to start new projects.

Remember.

If, when you look at your hand, you find only two or three of these minor lines, that's perfectly normal. Minor lines are nuances, not requirements. A palm with few lines usually describes someone calm, direct and practical; a palm with many, someone sensitive and receptive. Both are beautiful, and both tell a complete story.



Special signs and marks

The small accents of the palm

Besides the lines, small patterns appear on the palm: crosses, stars, squares, islands. These are the signs or special markings, and reading them is one of the most delicate parts of palmistry. They've often been interpreted in an alarmist way, as if a mark could foretell some misfortune. That's not how we work here. For me, each sign is an **accent** that underlines, strengthens or adds nuance to the energy of the place where it appears. Signs speak of periods of change, tiredness, learning or momentum, never of doom.

To read them, always follow two steps: first identify the sign and its general meaning; then look at where it is, because the same mark says different things on the mount of Jupiter than on the Head line.



STAR

Three or more short lines crossing at the same point, like a small asterisk. It's a sign of **intensity and brilliance**: a moment or area of life where energy is strongly concentrated. On the mount of Jupiter it speaks of ambition fulfilled and a capacity for leadership. On Apollo, of talent that becomes visible and gets recognised. On Mercury, of success in communication or business. On Saturn, of a period of great responsibility that demands focus and helps you mature. On the mount of the Moon, of an overflowing imagination. On a line, it marks a moment of very intense energy that's best channelled calmly.



CROSS

Two short, independent lines crossing to form an X or a plus sign. It represents a **crossroads**: a moment of decision, of choosing between paths. On the mount of Jupiter, tradition sees it as very favourable and links it to emotional bonds that bring joy. In the central space between the Head line and the Heart line, it's called the mystic cross and speaks of an interest in the spiritual and of intuition. On the Life line or the Fate line, it points to an important decision about your direction. On the mount of Saturn, a period of reflection on your responsibilities. Don't mistake a cross for two long lines that just happen to intersect.



SQUARE

Four lines forming a small square or rectangle. It's one of the kindest signs on the hand: it symbolises **protection, containment and resources**. When it surrounds a break or an island on any line, it shows that you have the tools and support to come through that period of change calmly. On the mount of Jupiter, it speaks of an ability to protect and guide others. On Venus, of a loving environment that holds you up. On Saturn, of caution and common sense. On the Head line, of a mind that knows how to keep itself safe from too much worry.



ISLAND

A small oval formed when a line splits in two and then rejoins. It represents a **period of divided energy**, of tiredness or scatter, when your strength is spread across several fronts. On the Life line, a time when it's wise to slow down and prioritise rest. On the Head line, a spell of mental overload or doubt. On the Heart line, emotional tiredness or a need to rearrange your affections. On the Fate line, doubts about your direction. On a mount, the energy of that mount is hard to express: an island on Apollo, for example, may point to creativity waiting for its moment. It's always a phase, and phases pass.



TRIANGLE

Three independent lines that meet to form a triangle, not just a gap between larger lines. It's a sign of **talent and applied intelligence**. On the mount of Jupiter, a gift for organising and leading. On Apollo, a practical artistic sense, able to turn inspiration into finished work. On Mercury, skill in communication, science or business. On Saturn, an interest in deep study. On the Moon, well-channelled intuition. On a line, it reinforces that line's qualities.



GRILLE

A mesh of fine lines crossing horizontally and vertically, like a small net, usually on a mount. It points to **scattered or restless energy**: plenty of drive, but spread in too many directions. On the mount of Jupiter, ambition moving on many fronts; on Venus, a great passion for life that's best paced; on the Moon, a very active imagination that can turn into worry if it isn't channelled; on Mercury, a quick mind that jumps from topic to topic. The advice is always the same: focus and choose.



CHAIN

A stretch of line made up of small links or a series of tiny islands, like a fine braid. It speaks of **ups and downs and sensitivity** to one's surroundings. On the Life line, fluctuating energy that thrives on stable routines. On the Head line, a restless mind that benefits from order and lists. On the Heart line, intense, changeable emotions and a great capacity to feel. When the chain turns into a clean line further along, it shows that the instability became learning and maturity.



FORK

A line that splits in two at the end, in the shape of a Y. It's the sign of **versatility**, of the ability to bring two approaches together. At the end of the Head line, it's the well-known writer's fork: logic and imagination joined. At the end of the Heart line, a balance between reason and emotion in matters of the heart. At the end of the Life line, a life divided between two places or two ways of living. At the end of the Fate line, career interests in two different fields. A fork at the start of a line usually points to varied origins or a beginning with several possibilities.



BRANCHES

Small lines sprouting from a major line. The general rule is simple: those that **rise** towards the fingers express drive, effort, hope and achievement; those that **fall** towards the wrist express moments of pause, doubt or energy drawing back. A branch rising towards Jupiter speaks of ambition; towards Saturn, of commitment and stability; towards Apollo, of creativity and fulfilment; towards Mercury, of success in communication. Falling branches aren't negative: they simply remind you that all growth needs its periods of rest.



BREAK

A point where a line is interrupted and carries on further along, sometimes shifted to one side. It's the sign of a **change of direction**. On the Life line, a change in the way you live: a move, a new chapter, a reinvention. On the Head line, a change in the way you think or in your interests. On the Heart line, a transformation in the way you experience affection. On the Fate line, a career turn. If the two sections overlap, the transition is gradual; if there's a square around it, you have protection and resources to see you through. Breaks aren't endings: they're doorways.

Before you draw any conclusions.

Signs are small and easy to confuse with passing creases, wrinkles in the skin or marks from manual work. Always check them

on both hands

and in

good light

, natural if possible, and look at them on different days. A sign that appears on both hands carries more weight than one that appears on only one. And above all, don't fixate on a single mark: one sign never defines a person. A reading is made from the whole picture, from the shape of the hand, the fingers, the mounts and the lines. If something unsettles you, come back to the central idea of this guide: the hand reflects tendencies and phases, and you always have the power to write your own story.



Time in the hand

How to place events in time, with care

One of the questions you'll hear most often once you start reading hands is "so when will that happen?" It's natural: we want to put a date on what we sense. Traditional palmistry offers a few ways of estimating the timing of certain changes, but I want you to be clear from the outset about one idea: they are approximations, not calendars. They help you place stages, not mark days in a diary.

♦ THE LIFE LINE AS A PATH IN STAGES

The Life line begins at the edge of the palm, between the thumb and the index finger, and descends around the mount of Venus towards the wrist. According to tradition, its starting point corresponds to childhood and, as it goes down, it passes through the different stages of your biography. Remember that this line speaks of your vitality, your energy and the big changes of course; its length has nothing to do with how many years you will live.

To find your bearings, you can use this simple method:

- 1 Imagine a vertical line dropping from the centre of the index finger until it crosses the Life line. That point is usually associated, more or less, with the age of ten.
- 2 Draw another imaginary line from the gap between the index and middle fingers. Where it meets the Life line sits, approximately, the stage of your twenties.
- 3 A third line, from the centre of the middle finger, would mark around the age of thirty-five.
- 4 From there, the stretch that curves towards the wrist represents maturity, spread more or less proportionally.

If in one of those stretches you find a branch rising, a line splitting off or a change in the depth of the stroke, tradition reads it as a period of transformation: a move, a new project, a shift in priorities. Never interpret it as something inevitable or necessarily negative.

♦ THE FATE LINE, FROM THE BOTTOM UP

The Fate line is read the opposite way to the Life line: it starts near the wrist and rises towards the middle finger. The most widespread convention says that the point where it crosses the Head line corresponds approximately to the age of thirty-five, and the point where it crosses the Heart

line, to fifty. Below the Head line lie youth and the first professional steps; above the Heart line, the calmest part of maturity.

So a Fate line that begins halfway up the palm may suggest that someone found their vocation or their own direction later on, and did so on their own. A change of direction or a jump in the line at the level of the Head line may speak of a rethinking of life around that age. They are clues for conversation, not closed conclusions.

With great caution.

Every hand has different proportions, and two people can measure the same line and arrive at different ages. That's why, when you talk about time, always use wide margins: "around your thirties", "in your youth", "in maturity". Avoid specific dates and never turn an estimate into a promise or a threat.

✦ WHY IT SHOULD BE TAKEN CALMLY

There are three weighty reasons for not becoming obsessed with time in the hand. The first is technical: the measuring methods are approximate and depend a great deal on the size and shape of each palm. The second is human: when someone hears a date, they tend to live waiting for it, and that can create expectations or fears that don't help them. The third is the most important: palmistry does not describe a fixed future, but tendencies. You decide what to do with them.

Use time as a map of seasons. You can say "it looks like there was an important change in your youth" and ask the person whether it resonates. Often, the most valuable part of a reading is precisely that conversation about the past, which helps us understand the present.

✦ HANDS CHANGE, AND SO DO YOU

This is perhaps the loveliest thing you'll discover: lines are not permanent. The major ones tend to stay stable for years, but the minor ones appear, lengthen, fade or disappear. A Sun line may become more marked during a time of personal satisfaction; the little fine lines can multiply in periods of heavy mental activity and soften when calm arrives.

That's why I encourage you to observe your hands over time, as you'll see in chapter 10 when you create your hand notebook. Comparing them every few months will teach you more than any book: you'll see with your own eyes that the hand accompanies the person, and not the other way round.

If you ever see something in your palm that you don't like, remember this idea: what is drawn there today can change tomorrow. The lines reflect who you are now, not who you are bound to be. And you, like your hands, are still in motion.



How to give a reading

A step-by-step method and an example

You already know the pieces: the shape of the hand, the fingers, the mounts, the lines and the signs. Now comes the most exciting part, which is putting them together. A reading is not a list of meanings recited one after another, but a coherent story about a person. To make it easier, I suggest a ten-step method. At first, follow it to the letter; with practice, you'll make it your own.

★ THE TEN-STEP METHOD

- 1 **Prepare the space.** Find a quiet place with good light, natural if possible. Sit facing the person or beside them, and give yourself a moment to breathe. A rushed reading shows.
- 2 **Explain the approach and ask permission.** Before touching a hand, say in two sentences what you're going to do: that palmistry is a tool for self-discovery, that it speaks of tendencies and not a fixed destiny, and that the person can stop you whenever they like. Ask whether they're happy for you to take their hand.
- 3 **Look at both hands.** According to tradition, the non-dominant hand shows the character you were born with, and the dominant hand what you have built along the way. Look at them together and notice the differences: they are often very revealing.
- 4 **Read the hand as a whole.** Before looking for lines, identify the hand type: Earth, Air, Fire or Water. Observe the proportion between palm and fingers, the texture of the skin and the firmness to the touch. This first glance gives you the general tone of the whole reading.
- 5 **Observe the fingers and the thumb.** Look for the longest or most striking finger compared with the others, the shape of the tips and the flexibility of the thumb. They will tell you how the person acts and what energy moves them.
- 6 **Go over the mounts.** Gently press each area and see which is most developed and which is flattest. The dominant mount usually points to the area of life where the person puts the most passion.
- 7 **Read the three major lines.** Start with the Life line, continue with the Head line and finish with the Heart line. Notice where each begins, its course, its depth and its end, and also how they relate to one another.
- 8 **Add the minor lines and the signs.** Check whether there is a Fate, Sun or Mercury line, and look for special markings. Don't get lost in every little stroke: stay with the ones that are clear and well formed.

- 9 **Look for recurring themes.** This is the heart of the method. If three different features point in the same direction, you've found a central theme. A lone indication carries little weight; several that coincide carry a lot.
- 10 **Close with a message and open the conversation.** Sum up the essentials in two or three clear ideas, always in a constructive key, and ask the person what resonated. Let them be the one to put the full stop.

A tip for getting started.

Keep a piece of paper at hand during your first readings and jot down each feature with a keyword. When you reach step nine, look at the list: the repeated themes will almost leap out at you.

✦ **WHAT TO SAY AND WHAT NOT TO SAY**

The words you choose matter as much as what you see. Someone who offers you their hand is showing you something intimate, and what you say may stay with that person for a long time. So it helps to be clear about a few guidelines.

What you can say:

- ✦ Talk about tendencies, talents and ways of being: "your hand shows a very creative mind".
- ✦ Use open expressions, such as "it seems", "it suggests", "it could indicate" or "tradition links it with".
- ✦ Ask questions: "do you recognise yourself in this?", "did you go through any big change in your youth?".
- ✦ Highlight strengths before challenges, and present challenges as ground for growth.
- ✦ Remind the person, at the beginning and at the end, that they are free to choose their own path.

What you must never say:

- ✦ Nothing about death, the length of a life, illnesses, accidents, pregnancies, the number of children or divorces. Palmistry isn't for that, and no line indicates it.
- ✦ No medical, legal or financial advice. If someone raises a concern of that kind, kindly encourage them to consult a professional.
- ✦ Absolute statements such as "you'll never be happy in a relationship" or "you're going to fail at work".
- ✦ Exact dates or closed predictions about what is going to happen.
- ✦ Judgements about the person's decisions or their way of living.

♦ HOW TO TALK ABOUT DIFFICULT THINGS WITH DELICACY

Sooner or later you'll see something in a hand that tradition associates with a complicated period: an island, a break, a chain. There's no need to hide it, but it should be presented with care. I suggest three keys.

The first is to **place it in context**. A single sign never defines a person; look at it alongside the rest of the hand. Often it appears next to another that balances it, such as a protective square or a line that carries on strongly after the interruption.

The second is to **speak in terms of learning**. Instead of "here's a problem", try "here I see a stage of more effort, the kind that ends up teaching a great deal". It isn't about dressing up the truth, but about telling it in a useful way.

The third is to **ask before asserting**. If the sign seems to belong to the past, let the person tell you what happened, if they feel like it. If it seems to point to what lies ahead, remind them that lines change and that what shows today can be transformed by their decisions.

And if you notice that someone is getting emotional or uneasy, stop. Breathe with them, acknowledge what they feel and don't carry on reading until they are calm. A good reading leaves the person feeling lighter, never with more worries.

EXAMPLE OF A READING

Imagine that Marta, aged thirty-eight, offers you her right hand, which is her dominant one. You've explained the approach, asked permission and taken a look at both of her hands: they're quite alike, although on the right the lines look more defined. You begin to observe.

Hand type. The palm is long, longer than it is wide, and the fingers are short in proportion. The skin is firm and warm to the touch. This is a Fire hand: it speaks of enthusiasm, drive and a person who feels alive when in action.

Fingers and thumb. The index finger is clearly longer than the ring finger, which tradition links with leadership and self-confidence. The thumb is strong and not very flexible: it indicates determination and persistence, and sometimes a certain difficulty in changing one's mind.

Mounts. The mount of Jupiter, below the index finger, is very developed and reinforces the idea of ambition and a wish to guide others. The mount of the Moon, at the base of the palm on the side opposite the thumb, is also full, which adds imagination and a rich inner world.

Major lines. The Life line traces a wide, deep curve around the mount of Venus: abundant energy and a taste for intense living. At its start, it is separate from the Head line, a feature associated with independence and making one's own decisions from a young age. The Head line is long and slopes gently towards the mount of the Moon, a sign of a creative mind that thinks in images and possibilities. The Heart line ends between the index and middle fingers with a gentle curve: warm yet realistic affection.

Minor line. The Fate line starts on the mount of the Moon and rises towards the middle finger, becoming clearer above the Head line. Tradition links it with a direction in life closely tied to contact with others, and with a vocation that takes hold in adulthood.

Sign. In the middle of the Head line there is a small island. It is usually interpreted as a stage of mental scatter, of doubts or of energy spread across too many fronts. After the island, the line carries on clean and clear.

How it all fits together. You go over your notes and see two themes that repeat. The first is initiative: the Fire hand, the long index finger, the mount of Jupiter, the firm thumb and the Life line separate from the Head line all say the same thing in different words. The second is imagination in the service of others: the Head line towards the Moon, the developed mount of the Moon and the Fate line that begins right there.

Then you say something like this: "Your hand speaks of a person with a great deal of initiative, who likes to take the reins and doesn't sit still when something matters to her. But it isn't only a practical energy: you have a very vivid imagination, and it seems your path grows when you bring that creativity into contact with people. I also see a stage in which you may have felt scattered, with your head in many places at once. Does that resonate? The lovely thing is that, after that stage, the line stays clear and firm. Perhaps that time taught you to choose better where you put your energy. If I had to give you just one idea, it would be this: your strength lies in leading from the imagination, and you decide that every day."

Marta tells you that a few years ago she tried to take on too much and that now she's focused on a project that excites her. You listen, thank her for her trust and close by reminding her that her

hand reflects who she is today, and that tomorrow it may tell something different.

Notice what you haven't done: you haven't put a date on the island, you haven't spoken of anything you can't see on solid grounds and you haven't presented any sign as inevitable. You've observed, put the pieces together and given Marta back an image of herself in which she can recognise herself and grow.



Your first month reading hands

A four-week practice plan

Learning to read hands is a lot like learning a language: at first you recognise single words, then sentences and, one fine day, you realise you understand a whole conversation without effort. Getting there doesn't take hours and hours of study, just a little practice every day. I suggest a four-week plan with simple tasks, designed so that you spend between fifteen and twenty minutes a day on it.

WEEK 1 · GET TO KNOW YOUR OWN HANDS

- ★ Observe both your hands for a few minutes each day, in good light, and notice something new every time.
- ★ Identify your hand type and write down why you think it's that one and not another.
- ★ Locate your mounts and your three major lines, and trace them with your fingertip.
- ★ Create your hand notebook and make your first entry using the template in this chapter.

WEEK 2 · OBSERVE WITHOUT INTERPRETING

- ★ Ask three or four people you trust for permission to look at their hands, just to observe.
- ★ Compare hand types, finger lengths and thumb shapes. Note down the differences.
- ★ Describe aloud the three major lines of each person without giving them any meaning yet.
- ★ Review the chapters on the fingers, the mounts and the major lines with these hands in mind.

WEEK 3 · MINOR LINES, SIGNS AND FIRST INTERPRETATIONS

- ✦ Look for minor lines on the hands you already know: Fate, Sun, Mercury, Intuition.
- ✦ Practise recognising special signs with enlarged photos; don't fixate on every stroke.
- ✦ Do ten-minute mini-readings focused on a single aspect, such as how someone thinks or loves.
- ✦ Ask each person what resonated with them and write down their answers.

WEEK 4 · YOUR FIRST COMPLETE READING

- ✦ Do two or three complete readings following the ten-step method from the previous chapter.
- ✦ After each one, write down the themes that repeated and the message you gave.
- ✦ Reread your first entry from week 1 and note what you can see now that escaped you before.
- ✦ Choose a topic you'd like to explore further next month: the fingers, the signs or time in the hand.

At the end of the month you won't be an expert, and you don't need to be. You'll have built a habit, you'll have your first readings under your belt and, above all, you'll have started to look at hands with different eyes.

✦ YOUR HAND NOTEBOOK

Your hand notebook will be your best teacher. In it you'll record your own palms over time, and also those of the people who let you practise on them. It will help you check your progress and see with your own eyes how the lines change. It can be a notebook with plain pages or a folder on your computer or phone; what matters is that you use it consistently.

If you prefer to trace your hand, rest your palm wide open on a blank sheet and draw the outline with a soft pencil. Then, with your hand beside the paper, sketch freehand the major lines and any minor lines you can see clearly. You're not after a work of art, but a faithful map. If you feel adventurous, you can get a more precise print: spread a thin layer of washable stamp ink over the palm with a small roller and press it onto the paper, gently pushing down on the centre of the hand so it marks well.

If you prefer to photograph it, find natural light coming from the side, because it brings out the relief of the lines. Place your hand on a plain background, with the fingers slightly apart and relaxed, and hold your phone parallel to the palm, about thirty centimetres away. Take one photo of each whole hand and another, closer, of the central area. Always repeat the same conditions so the comparisons are fair.

The ideal is to make a new entry every three or four months. Put the date on each page and also note how you're feeling at this stage: what's occupying you, what excites you, what you're changing. Over time, this notebook will become a very special diary, in which your hand and your life tell each other their stories.

Other people's hands deserve care too.

If you trace or photograph someone else's hand, ask their permission first and explain why you're doing it. Keep those images somewhere private, don't share them without their consent and delete them if they ask you to. They are as personal as a portrait.

When you have several entries, set aside some time to compare them calmly. Place two dates side by side and go over the hand section by section: first the outline and the mounts, then the major lines and, lastly, the minor lines and the signs. Mark in one colour what stays the same and in another what has changed. You'll be amazed at how much a palm moves in just a year, and how well those changes echo what you've lived through.

For each entry, you can copy this template:

Date:

Hand observed (right or left, dominant or not):

Hand type:

Most prominent finger:

Dominant mount:

Life line:

Head line:

Heart line:

Signs and minor lines:

My interpretation:

♦ EXERCISES

These exercises will help you sharpen your eye. Do them at your own pace and come back to them whenever you want to review.

- ♦ **The four elements game.** Find twenty photographs of hands in magazines, books or online and sort them into Earth, Air, Fire or Water. When you're torn between two types, write down which features make you hesitate.

- ★ **One line, three hands.** Pick the Head line and compare it across three different people. Describe its length, direction and depth, and write one sentence about the way of thinking each one suggests.
- ★ **Your hand in three words.** Sum up your own hand in three adjectives. Then ask someone you trust to describe you with three others. Compare the two lists and reflect on the overlaps and the surprises.
- ★ **Two hands, one story.** Compare your dominant hand with your non-dominant one and write a paragraph about what has changed between the character you were born with and the person you've been building.
- ★ **The five-minute reading.** Set a timer and give someone a short reading, focusing on one central theme. This exercise trains you to go to the essentials and not get lost in the details.

Quick reference

The essentials at a glance

♦ HAND TYPES

ITEM	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	KEY MEANING
Earth	Square palm, short fingers, firm skin	Practical sense, steadiness, being rooted
Air	Square palm, long fingers	Agile mind, communication, curiosity
Fire	Long palm, short fingers	Enthusiasm, drive, action
Water	Long palm, long and slender fingers	Sensitivity, intuition, emotional world

♦ FINGERS

ITEM	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	KEY MEANING
Thumb	Length, firmness and flexibility	Willpower, logic, ability to adapt
Index (Jupiter)	Length compared with the ring finger	Ambition, leadership, self-esteem
Middle (Saturn)	Straightness and length	Responsibility, sense of duty, balance
Ring (Apollo)	Length compared with the index finger	Creativity, aesthetic taste, desire to shine
Little (Mercury)	Length and separation from the ring finger	Communication, wit, persuasion

♦ MOUNTS

ITEM	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	KEY MEANING
Jupiter	Below the index finger	Ambition, leadership, confidence
Saturn	Below the middle finger	Reflection, discipline, sense of responsibility
Apollo	Below the ring finger	Creativity, joy, desire for recognition

Mercury	Below the little finger	Communication, mental agility, shrewdness
Mars positive	Next to the thumb, between the index finger and Venus	Courage, initiative, ability to stand up for yourself
Plain of Mars	Centre of the palm	Balance between action and restraint
Mars negative	Outer edge, between Mercury and the Moon	Resilience, perseverance, self-control
Venus	Base of the thumb	Affection, vitality, enjoyment of the senses
Moon	Base of the palm, side opposite the thumb	Imagination, intuition, inner world

✦ LINES

ITEM	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	KEY MEANING
Life	Curves around Venus; breadth and depth	Energy, vitality, big changes of course
Head	Crosses the palm; length and direction	Way of thinking, concentration, creativity
Heart	Below the fingers; ending and curvature	Way of loving and expressing emotions
Fate	Rises towards the middle finger; origin and continuity	Sense of direction, vocation, purpose
Sun	Rises towards the ring finger	Fulfilment, creativity, recognition
Mercury	Rises towards the little finger	Communication, sharpness, practical sense
Intuition	Arc from the Moon towards Mercury	Subtle perception, inner instinct
Girdle of Venus	Semicircle above the Heart line	Intense emotional sensitivity
Ring of Solomon	Arc at the base of the index finger	Wisdom, desire to understand others
Relationship	Horizontal strokes below the little finger, on the edge	Significant emotional bonds
Bracelets	Lines on the wrist; clarity and continuity	Stability, being rooted, personal foundation



Farewell

Your hands keep talking

We've reached the end of this guide together, but your journey with hands has really only just begun. You now know how to recognise the four elements, read the fingers and the mounts, follow the lines and decipher their signs. Above all, you know something worth more than any table: that every hand is a living story, and that reading one is an act of listening.

I'd like you to hold on to three ideas. The first, that palmistry is a tool for knowing yourself and for enjoyment, not a dictation of what awaits you. The second, that your hands change because you change: what you see in your palm today is a snapshot of the moment, not a sealed destiny. The third, that when you read another person you are holding something very delicate; always do it with respect, with humility and with affection.

Don't be in a hurry. There will be days when everything falls into place and others when a hand looks like a hieroglyph. That's normal. Go back to your notebook, review the reference tables, compare your entries and keep practising. The eye is sharpened slowly, just as the ear is with music, and one day you'll surprise yourself reading with an ease that would seem unthinkable to you today.

If you'd like to keep exploring, I'll be waiting for you at **taraoraculo.com**. There you'll find other ways of looking inward, new readings and content that will grow along with you. Come back whenever you need to, whether to clear up a doubt, to check what you're seeing in a hand or simply to give yourself a moment of calm and reflection.

Thank you for trusting me and for giving your time to this learning. It moves me to think that, somewhere, someone is opening their hands in the light of a window and looking at them for the first time with curiosity and tenderness. I hope that person is you, today and many times again.

Take care of yourself, listen to yourself and never forget that the last word on your life is yours.

May your hands guide you,

Tara